In My Loyalty

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/44319703.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
More characters to be added, Medieval AU, but not the bad things just for the vibes, Magicat Catra, Knight/princess au, Knight Adora, Princess Catra, Trans Adora, Trans Female Character, Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra, Smut, Catra Is a Tease, top adora, Bottom Catra, Porn With Plot, Smut first chapter, Fluff and Angst, Fluff and Smut, Itll end well i promise, Angst

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by Jingujiwa

Summary

The magicat blinks once before a devilish smirk emerges on her pretty features. She ducks her head until she is level with the bottom of Adora's breastplate, opening her round lips and placing the flat of her tongue on the center of the metal, dragging it up torturously slow. Her eyes flick upwards to meet the taller woman's cloudy blue ones as she comes closer to her face again, not drawing her tongue away until it's seconds from her bare throat. She feels like dying on the spot.
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Adora has been Catra's guard for a year. She knows her- better than anyone, and would lay her life on the line to protect her, even though she doesn't need to. Catra has been acting differently than usual and seems to have become more apathetic.

**COMPLETED

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Loyalty

A warm exhale to the cold fall air. A careful, meticulously curated plan.

A winning battle. They never stood a chance.

Adora doesn't get called from her station often. If and when she is- she plans for a full frontal attack, a quick end. She can't be away from her duties for too long, the very fine print of her job is that she's on watch twenty-four-seven. Sometimes she wonders if these council members remember that-or, more honestly, if they care enough. Even on the slim chance anyone could do her job as well as her- which she doubts, it's not like she would trust them too anyway. She’s come to realize that the general’s council doesn’t underestimate the abilities of her assignment per se, but rather they overestimate how much one person can truly protect themselves from the eyes of danger. As fierce and powerful they may be, it’s hard to stay safe when focused on your own livelihood. And so that is where she needs to return to, more than anything. The battle she was sent to conquer has been won, almost as soon as it had started. Some of the soldiers passing by her in cadence quickly nod to her in thanks for her support. Adora acknowledges them as well, it would be rude not to. With her generals leading, Adora soon pulls the reign on her horse, following after the final few back towards the castle. Back towards her home, back to her station, back to her Princess.

-//-

After handing her horse over to the stable handlers Adora makes towards her chambers only to be stopped by one of her lower-ranked guards that quickly informs her that the Princess is waiting for her in her room. She *knows,* that’s why she’s rushing.

Adora settles for a curt grunt. “I’m aware. That’s why I’m trying to clean up *quickly.* Now, if you don't mind-” She starts to move again before she’s promptly cut off. She shoots a glare at the woman who stopped her.

“Sh-she requested for you upon arrival,” She stutters out.

Adora sighs. Her shower will have to wait, she supposes. If her majesty minds the smell, that’s on her.

She makes her way towards the corridor the chamber lies in. Night had fallen by the time they’d arrived, meaning the sunken corridors of Halfmoon were dimly lit with the fire of torches against the mossy stone walls. Even if she hadn’t walked this route a thousand times before and had it practically burned into muscle memory, she doesn’t find it hard to see. She’s been in Halfmoon for many years. She grew up here as a young teen, trained as a knight throughout her teenage years, and was inducted into the high court of knights by the time she was twenty-two. She lived in the castle as a royal guard for a year before she was reassigned as a personal guard. A personal guard to no other than whose door she currently stands at. The pair of fill-ins stationed outside the ornate and decorative wood doors nod to her as they make their leave, no longer needed.

She steels herself, takes a breath, and knocks the designed rhythm on the doors.

Tap tap. Tap.

The sweet, husky voice inside the room calls out.

“Enter.”

Adora pushes the heavy wood open, stepping inside and turning to latch the locks behind her quickly. Once they're secure in place she turns towards her ward, who isn’t facing her at the moment. She’s facing the table next to her bed, moving in a way that looks like she’s lighting a candle. She often does, late at night. Adora suspects she likes the calming aroma and smell of them.

“M’lady,” she addresses, bowing curtly before her.

“Catra,” she states, quickly lighting the candle but remaining faced away from her. “You know that.”

Adora stutters on her words. Only the Princess manages to knock her off her guard like this. “C-catra, the mission was a success and I return to your side again victorious."

She watches as her eyes fall heavy, a small smirk breaking out on her curved lips as she watches her with gold and sapphire-lit eyes that nearly glow in the dark light of the chambers. Adora feels her chest grow heavy with the loyalty she feels towards this woman. She would charge into battle anytime if it was in her name.

Catra, her Princess, is undeniably the most beautiful and utmost perfect example of Halfmoon’s characteristics and charm of its people. Lithe as she is, she carries herself with such poise and confidence that any man would be a downright fool to challenge or question her expertise. She rules with kindness, passion, and an unwavering justice that is always fair. She is fierce, she is amazing, and she is so, so beautiful in the eyes of her kingdom. She wears the colors of Halfmoon- as she usually does. Red with gold accents draped over her body in soft and luxurious chiffon. Her curves are wonderfully defined from the fabric falling ever so gently over her tan skin, bringing focus to every prominent feature of her body. The slight slope of her shoulders, the small juts of her hips, and the delicate peaks of her breasts. Which, by candlelight, show the faint color of her nipples through the fabric. Adora feels unbearably out of place seeing the Princess in such a compromising position. She averts her eyes before she can catch her disrespectful gaze.

"Why do you do that?" She asks.

Adora’s heart stops, immediately thinking the worst, as always. Maybe she's just trained that way. She stutters but no words slip

out of her mouth.

Catra huffs. "Princess. M'lady. *Your Highness* ," she mocks the last part. "You know my name by now, it's been a year."

She shifts nervously on her feet, unsure of how to answer. "I…do know your name. I just…wish to respect you, Catra."

She steels her gaze on her knight who still stands from across the room. "You respect me by calling me my name."

"Well, I guess, as far as that goes you should do the same."

Adora has been her guard for a while now. She knows, typically, personal guards for royal patrons don't speak to each other in this manner. But they have always been different. Such casual jabs like this in their conversations have always been them. It makes the Princess more comfortable with her constant companion, and its reward is being brokered by seeing her face finally light up for the first time since she entered the room. Adora feels that familiar flutter in her chest once again.

"Was there a reason you called for me before I could clean off the winnings of my battle?"

"I grew wary of not having my guard by me for so long, is that such a crime?"

Adora hums, knowing very well the Princess is no damsel. Catra grins, knowing she didn't play it well.

"I know you best to know you're no damsel in distress, Catra."

"You do know me the best, don't you?"

"I am your guard, after all."

For some reason, Catra's face falls again. Adora feels her gut wrench in worry, not able to stop herself from feeling that she caused it. Actually, she's sure she did, she just doesn't know how.

"My lady-"

"Why are you here, Adora?"

To say she was confused would be an understatement. First, she calls her here as soon as she steps foot inside the castle without a change to change or clean the dirt off herself. Then, she's chastised for using her proper titles, and when she finally gets her to break a smile they're back to where they're started. Something is different with her. She doesn't know what it is, but the Princess is not her usual self. It puts Adora on edge. "You, uh, called for me, your-" Catra's eyes squint. "Catra."

She sighs, exasperated. "No. Here, with me. Why are you my guard?"

Adora stumbles over her words, overcome with nerves at this line of questioning. Catra usually catches her off guard, but not like this. This, to Adora, is wholly unprecedented and out of left field. She struggles to get the words out. “I- I’m your guard like I wished to be.”

Catra’s gaze grows heavy as she stares at her. Her gaze unrelenting and burning Adora’s face under its hold. “Why?”

“I’ve trained to be here since I was young-”

“Why?” She interrupts again. Adora is becoming frustrated quickly.

“To be by your side-”

“Adora.”

“To protect you-”

“You-”

“To serve you.”

The blonde has almost no time to think before the Princess is sweeping across the room to her, lips crashing against hers harshly as her perfectly manicured hands secure her face. Adora’s

arms shoot out on instinct to catch her, holding her close to her as she stretches up to reach her lips. Her head is a scrambled mess. Her patron, the Princess of Halfmoon is kissing her like she’s some lifelong dream and as if she isn’t already the most perfect being on the planet herself. She is, without a doubt, completely undeserving of this. She can't help but feel she's simply underwhelming compared to Catra. Compared to her perfect body draped in the finest red silk, her soft shoulders slipping out of the hem with her sweet and soft lips moving against hers. Adora is brutally reminded of how much she must smell from her battle. Her armor is still on, caked in dirt, ash, and blood from her enemies and Catra simply doesn't deserve to have such filth transferred to her lovely skin.

" *Mn* - Catra, wait," she uses the hands that fled to Catra's hips to push down softly and urge her away from her lips.

"Why?" She whispers, staying close to her face.

Adora sighs. "Is that the only word you know of today?" She scolds. "My armor is filthy."

She hums, inching closer to her face again. Adora's cheeks burn. "Don't care. I'm not a porcelain doll, 'Dora."

Adora swallows a lump in her throat she didn't know was there, looking down into the beautiful sapphire-gold of her eyes. "I…I can't let you dirty yourself like that."

The magicat blinks once before a devilish smirk emerges on her pretty features. She ducks her head until she is level with the bottom of Adora's breastplate, opening her round lips and placing the flat of her tongue on the center of the metal, dragging it up torturously slow. Her eyes flick upwards to meet the taller woman's cloudy blue ones as she comes closer to her face again, not drawing her tongue away until it's seconds from her bare throat. She feels like dying on the spot.

Catra moves her hands down to grip the corners of Adora’s breastplate, tugging her towards her with each step she takes backward. Against her better judgment, Adora follows her pull like a captain falling helplessly enamored with a siren’s call. The issue with that; however, is that Catra is no dangerous sea creature with a magical song designed for such callousness- yet Adora still finds herself just as transfixed with her.

"You want to serve me?"

Oh, Goddess, save her. She nods numbly.

"Then lay me out and *take me."*

Adora chokes on air. Her years of brutal training, her loyalty to the crown, and her solemn oath are all flying out the window for this one moment. All for her.

"Catra," she mumbles between parted lips. Their faces are so close their noses brush against each other softly, hot breaths mingling together. "This is treason."

"They'd never get you," Catra surges forward again and this time Adora accepts her lips openly, tongue quickly sliding into her warm mouth. The back of Catra's legs hit the edge of her bed and suddenly they're falling onto her round mattress draped in dark red sheets. Adora wraps her arm around her waist and braces their fall with her right arm, leaving her folded over her small body. “I’d never let them.”

She wants.

She wants she wants she wants

This time Adora is the one to lay claim on her lips first, anyone would be a fool not to when she is laying so openly before them. Suddenly hat thought has her trying to stamp down a burning feeling twisting in her gut. It seems her protectiveness transfers into other activities, as well.

When she parts, the Princess is looking up at her so dreamily, like someone painted the goddess of beauty with the stars and brought her to life. For some reason, that goddess has decided to lay herself before Adora of all people. Her chestnut hair feathered around her head in a luxurious halo, some parts of it resting against her arms that lie lethargically above her head on the plush mattress. Her robe, previously beginning to slide off her shoulders has now cascaded down to the very tops of her breasts with the fall, a slight tug away from exposing them completely. She tries not to stare too long at her breasts which are perfect and small and could probably fit in the palm of Adora’s calloused hand like they belong there, and keeps her eyes focused on the features of her face. Catra is watching her and waiting, she can tell. She looks up to be met with a relaxed expression with hooded eyes that carries a small smile once their eyes meet, and suddenly she has never felt more seen than how this woman looks at her.

"Show me your desire," she whispers.

Adora pulls the arm out from under Catra’s body and moves it down the side of her willowy frame, hand landing on her hips and grabbing the skin there, fighting the overwhelming urge to squeeze and lay claim. "I do not want to be too much for you, Catra."

She brings clawed hands up to her guard's neck, placing them on the sides and softly dragging them up until they cup the strong line of her jaw. Her thumbs caress gentle strokes on her warm cheeks. "I fear you underestimate me," she murmurs.

Adora is taken aback by that statement. "Never."

"Then show me. Get rough, Adora. Take me. Please, show me-" she stops suddenly, desperation in her raspy voice cut short as her cheeks grow pink and quickly adverts her gaze from Adora's hazy one. She takes a breath before her striking eyes flick back to her. "Show me what I mean to you."

Adora cannot breathe. She’s faced hideous foes, countered impossible odds in battle, been through the most rigorous and brutal training to become a knight in the high court to serve this sole woman and this Princess- her Catra has made her into an absolute babbling mess of herself. She's lost herself, and she doesn't know if she wants to find it if it leads to moments like these. "The armor?"

"Off," she commands, so Adora listens.

She places a quick kiss on the peak of her sharp nose before standing upright and beginning to disarm her battle-worn armor. Catra's arms fall back around her head as she does so, watching her take off her heavy metal plates followed by the chainmail and arming wear until she's down to her ivory tunic and grey pants. Catra waits patiently all the while, looking at her like she’s the most beautiful thing she's ever laid eyes upon- lethargic and as if she’s not covered in grime. Adora can wait no longer until she’s surging forward again, capturing the Princess’ plush lips and pulling a wonderful squeak out of her. Adora’s hands are quickly moving down her body, self-restraint be damned. She takes her time reveling in her soft skin and pleasantly warm mouth, quickly finding the top of her sheer nightgown. Gently, she pulls apart the soft folds of her delicate gown, exposing the small peaks of her breasts to the open air. Adora is absolutely transfixed. She can feel Catra’s eyes on her, but her gaze is focused on the beautiful swells before her. Tentatively, in case Catra would signal for her to stop, she moves one hand up to caress her chest. Adora feels her face instantly grow warm as she cups her breast. She’s never been blessed enough to consort another woman, never met anyone who beckoned her touch as this one does. She finds, though, that she would be happy if she was to never again find another woman in exchange for this.

Stars, what does that mean?

Her thumb begins to toy with her nipple, pressing it down and flicking before pinching it together with her thumb and pointer finger. Catra lets out a satisfied hum after finally feeling some

pressure and begins to work her hands around Adora's waist, loosening the strings of her trousers. Her other hand moves to cup her other breast as well, both fitting in the palms of her hands perfectly just as she imagined. At the same time, Catra loosens her bottoms enough to let them fall.

"Oh, stars 'Dor. You're *huge."*

If Adora said she was blushing before she was lying. She can admit she may be a bit girthy, but she never considered herself to be any more than average. "I'm- I'm sorry. If it's too much-"

"Absolutely not," she cuts off. "You're going to ruin me with that thing."

She's dead. She must have died in battle without even realizing it. There's no other explanation. "Prin-"

Adora yelps as Catra grabs her shoulders suddenly and roughly pulls her down closer to her face. She almost growls at her as she speaks. "Stop it. Stop with the self-doubt. I can see it on your face every time I say something. I want this. I've wanted this for so long you don't even know," her hand moves down her chest. "I want you," down the planes of her stomach. "Here," over her beautifully hairy mound. "Inside me," and into the slick heat of her pussy.

Catra begins to finger herself tenderly, staring up at Adora with lustful eyes and raised eyebrows as her beautiful lips part with a soft, almost silent *'oh.'* She moves two of her fingers in and out slowly, plunging to the knuckle before pulling back and rubbing her clit before sliding back inside herself. The heady gasps she lets out all the while are nothing short of music. A perfect melody as she becomes absolutely entranced watching this goddess of a woman fuck herself underneath her.

"D-don't just, just watch," she trips.

Adora smirks. "Just watch, you said?" Catra whines.

Adora wants to ask something. Something she feels she has no right to ask, no right to experience in her life, yet she wants to. Because at this small moment in time Catra has made it seem like she wants nothing more than to feel her desires. Watching her is so pleasant, it is a gift in its own right, but Catra has asked her to stop doubting herself, and she wants nothing more than to please her.

"'Dora," she whines again, more petulant.

"I have an idea," she breaks her silence. "I want you to get yourself ready for me," she pushes down the feeling of guilt in her chest at asking that and focuses on Catra's half-lidded eyes instead. She acknowledges the quick flick of her tail in the corner of her eye, as well. "You said I was big, didn't you?"

Catra gasps, smiling up at Adora with a pretty rosy blush on her sharp cheeks. "Yes, m-my Knight," Adora's heart stutters at having the script flipped on her like this. Before she knows it she can feel her hand on her fully erect shaft, giving it soft strokes as she pumps her shine-covered fingers out of herself quicker. Adora can start to hear the gush of her bodily fluids as she plunges in, and she relishes in the sounds of success of having her consort so turned on. Catra is moaning rhythmically under her, chest heaving softly with her butterfly chorus of *'ah's.'* The blonde leans down, pressing firm kisses against the magicat's hanging jaw. "You're doing so well," she whispers, nosing against her jawline. "Keep going for me. You want me inside you, don't you?"

Catra releases a breathy *yes.*

"Then make room."

Catra lets out a sound short of a choked gasp and tilts her chin up, falling deep in her arousal. Her eyes are closed, mouth agape eyebrows raised as her head tilts back into the mattress. Her hair feathers out around her in the mussed-up sheets, leaving it to fall and curl around her face and shoulders like a silken brown waterfall. Her shoulders are bare, the gown having slid down her

biceps after Adora parted it, and show the faintest spatter of freckles against it. Adora wants to kiss every single one as tribute.

She leans down to the curve of her neck and shoulder, pressing gentle kisses and nips there as Catra's hand on her cock becomes more sporadic in its strokes. She smiles into her skin, knowing she is becoming too devoured and needy to evenly split her attention. "S-shut up," she complains, reading the blonde's mind.

Adora chuckles. "Come on. Harder, baby," her heart drops in her stomach and she mentally kicks herself for letting that slip, but Catra doesn't seem to notice.

"Adora- *ah,* now. Put it in," she pleads.

"A-are you sure? We don't need to rush, I can wait however long- as long as you're comfortable."

"Please," she drags out the whine, sounding helpless. "Put it in me."

Adora is stuck in place, frozen by the realization that she's about to put her cock in the Princess of Halfmoon. Catra grows impatient quickly, as if it had ever been one of her core virtues, and swings her legs around Adora's waist to drag her in. Her shaft bumps against her pussy, sliding upwards against the hair so they are pressed together, but not inside. Not yet.

She moves a hand down to grab hold of the base of her shaft, putting pressure against the soft folds there. "I'll stop immediately if you want me to, no matter what. I need you to understand that."

The magicat's arms are back resting around her head, smiling softly up at Adora like…like she means something, after all. "I do. I trust you, Adora."

Trust. She trusts her.

More than anything, Adora trusts her too.

She backs up a little, slowly sliding the head of her cock against her parted lips, dragging more of her pre-cum along the length of her pearly entrance. Gently, she pushes into her wet heat, the head of her shaft finding purchase easily in her new favorite place on Etheria. The knight starts out slowly, taking her time to push in and watch the stretch of her lips as she accommodates to her girth. Catra is biting her bottom lip as they stare at each other, gazes locked as they experience this new sensation together. Her face tells her everything she needs to know.

Hard. Fast. Rough. Whatever she gives her, she wants it all.

As soon as she bottoms out, stuck in that glorious, silky wet heat, she pulls out and quickly snaps her hips back in. Catra throws her head back and releases a guttural grunt, cheeks turning pink at the sound and clearly embarrassed by her reaction.

The blonde begins in a rhythm, pulling out and diving back in quicker as she builds pace. "Please, don't be embarrassed," she breathes. "Give me *everything* ."

Catra grunts, jerking her head once in a quick nod as she grips the plush red and orange pillows.

Adora isn't sure what to call what they're doing. Sex? Fucking? Those seem too crude and almost dumb down the situation she's in, and love-making seems too far off from the truth. Catra could not love her- she does not expect her to, but she will make sure she cherishes this gift from her to the day she dies. To do that, though, she must first make sure it's just as memorable for the brunette.

Catra is letting out small choruses of noises each time Adora bears into her body. Her eyes have opened now, peaking at her through heavy, dark lashes. Her jewel eyes bear the tiniest bit of tears in the corner.

"Are you okay?"Adora asks, alarmed.

She lets out a small whine, averting her eyes away before answering. “Feels good,” is all she manages. Adora feels her heart soften in her chest. What a stubborn, beautiful, fierce woman.

She ends her ministrations with one last hard thrust that makes Catra’s groan catch and rattle in her throat before promptly pulling out. Catra whines, exasperated and leans up on her elbows to glare at the blonde with heavy breaths. “Why?” she croaks.

Adora can appreciate that the magicat looks well fucked. Rosy cheeks with plump, well-kissed lips- that could probably be kissed a lot more. Messy brown locks of hair curling around her shoulders and sticking up in places where she buried the crown of her head into the mattress in pleasure, and perfectly small breasts spilling out of her open robe. She is without a doubt the definition of beauty. “Turn around,” she instructs.

Catra’s glaze glosses over, the petulant look on her face slipping away as lust takes over once again. Slowly, as if to tease Adora, she takes her time turning her body over. She lifts her leg slowly, dragging it up along her calf before bending her knee and using it to flip herself over. She pushes her chest out as she flips to accentuate her tits before propping herself up on her elbows and throwing a smug look back over her shoulder, curls pillowing around her face. Adora, knowing her and knowing her games- knows she is simply challenging her and aiming for a reaction. She grabs her hips and tugs her back down closer to the edge of her bed, making her squeak out loud in surprise. She smirks. “Ready?”

The magicat nods, enthusiasm evident on her features, so Adora slides back in.

Her moans are downright ethereal.

Each thrust feels like it could be her very last. The sounds being pulled from Catra’s mouth are downright filthy, so much so that Adora thinks she would be able to get off on them alone. The way her body feels around her cock makes her want to think they were

made for each other, but Adora doesn’t let herself dwell on that thought for too long. A Princess as fine as her could never belong to someone with hands so blood-stained.

“A-Adora,” she moans. She can feel her heart do flips in her chest at how desperate and delirious she sounds for her. She burrows her face in crumpled sheets as she forms a fist next to her folded ear, the other tangled in her wild hair for purchase.

She wants to protect her, she wants to lay claim to her like she belongs to her, like she could belong to no one else but her. She has no idea where these sinful possessive thoughts have started to come from but she finds them devouring her entirely in a wave of lust. She wants Catra's body. She wants to make Catra feel like she belongs to her and she never wants to stop hearing these noises for the rest of her life. The hands controlling her hips tighten as she continues to pull her back onto her cock.

Catra’s fist unclenches for a brief moment before readjusting to another spot on her bed. Adora continues to pound into her in a frenzy, the loud clap of skin against skin echoing around the decorated chamber, and leans so she folds over her smaller body. She wouldn’t go so far as to say she is twice the Princess’ size, but she is quite noticeably smaller than her counterpart. Adora has been trained for years to be a heavy hitter, the ideal forefront of each battle, and has purposefully trained to gain as much muscle mass as possible. To put it bluntly, her arms are wide, and her strength isn’t to be treated as any joke. Yet where Adora may reign in strength, Catra easily counters her in agility and speed. The Magicats are not to be underestimated. And, after living here in their beautiful kingdom for so many years she’s come to see herself as a savant for some of their more typical fighting tactics. Catra, on the other hand, always seems to throw her for a loop.

One of her hands darts upwards and grabs onto Adora's loose locks, causing her to exclaim outloud and pulls her down until she pressed up against her back, almost completely covering her like a shroud.

"Catra, Princess, I'm going to-" Adora grunts, doing her best to keep the pressure building inside her at bay. Catra is underneath her, moaning and claws ripping the sheets on her bed into slivers of fabric.

"Cum in me- *ah* , please, please," she rattles off.

Adora can not deny her, and she can not find the willpower to care about any future consequences at this moment as her most important goal is centered before her. All she feels is Catra, all she hears is Catra, and all she sees is *Catra* . What bliss it is.

She cums, hard, like a band snapped inside the bottom of her gut and let loose all of the built up energy inside of her. Her rough hands grip the brunette's hips, maybe a little too harshly, as she spills into her with low and guttoral moan. Catra cums then too, nails ripping into the mattress so harshly Adora can hear it *rip* before she's exclaiming her own release in a high-pitched wail. Stricken with the sudden fear of being caught, she quickly darts her hands to Catra's open mouth, covering it with her hand as she continues to gently guide them through both of their orgasms, gently moving. As their breathing and calming movements subside, Catra's face slips away from her hand as she lets herself fall into her bed, releasing a breath on impact.

Adora takes a few minutes to gather herself, breathing heavily as tough she had just run a marathon. "Where are your cloths?"

Catra doesn't lift her head but points to the vanity across her room. Adora makes her way over there, pants in tow, and grabs a couple of washcloths. She uses one to clean herself off before putting her pants back on and bringing the rest she grabbed back over to Catra who finally sits up to take one. As she adjusts herself, Adora makes idle use of her hands to fix the loosened and untied robe around her body. When she's done she takes the cloths back towards her changing area where she tucks them away in Catra's dirty clothes from the day, knowing it is hidden safely from plain sight if anyone were to enter. She tries not to imagine how the rest of the castle would react to seeing them like

this. She also chooses to ignore the jealous pit in her stomach growing in her stomach. Before she's able to turn around to tend to her more, she's stopped in her tracks by a sudden phrase, spoken resolute.

"We need to talk, 'Dor."

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora feels her anxiety weigh on her heavier than ever. No good-natured conversation ever starts well or ends well with that phrase. She instantly fears she may have done something wrong. Did she upset her? Did she do something she didn't like? Did she already regret doing this with her? She wouldn't blame her, she's just a knight for crying out loud. She just came from a battle full of blood and grit and sweat- she doesn't have any right to bed a Princess. She needs to only serve her, and yet she has laid her out on her bed in the privacy of her own room. Adora is disgusted with herself and the nerves in her stomach do nothing but churn into a tight knot at the second. "Y-yes?"

Catra's soft ears have fallen, pressed closer to the side of her head meaning she's either shy, embarrassed, or sad. All of which Adora wants no part in having caused her, nevertheless having her feel that way at all. "I'm going to ask you something, and I need you to be honest with me, okay? No judgment whatsoever, I promise, but-... Please, what do I mean to you?"

Adora knows she isn't asking her from the standpoint of a knight due to their earlier conversation. She knows she's looking for something more that she didn't provide earlier but the truth is- Adora isn't sure herself. What does Catra mean to her? She obviously wishes to serve her more than anything else. She wants to see her smile, she wants her to enjoy her lavish life to the fullest, to have a strong and successful rule, to be able to live free and…love freely. She wants to see her enjoy her life, and she would lay her own life on the line before she let anything stop that. She also supposes the duty she feels here is stronger than any other she's felt before. Whichever, it'll help her do her job better.

“I want you to have a life you’re proud of. I want you to live happily, freely, with the long reign your kindness deserves.”

But it must still not be what Catra is looking for. Her ears remain flat against her wild hair, eyes pleading as she looks at the blonde. Adora blows out an exasperated breath.

“And what about you? What do you want, Adora?”

“I-" She freezes. Her Highness is very good at putting her on the spot when she least expects it. "What I want is not important here.”

Her eyes narrow. “Adora. You are a person, not just a knight. You deserve to have dreams outside of the castle, outside of being a knight. What do you want?” She asks again.

She stands her ground. "I wish to serve you."

"No! Adora, can't you see? It's more than that. Please tell me you see that!" She stops, standing like she was almost frozen and suddenly looking the meekest she's ever seen her whole life. "Please tell me you feel it too," she whispers.

"Catra…" Adora's stomach drops at the sound of the brunette's heartbroken plea. What kind of a knight would she be to admit she's fallen for her princess? How would it be received by the castle? Once word got out, Adora would be done for. She feels turmoil building in her gut. Neither answer could end well for one or the other. One would get hurt, one would be decommissioned or they would be separated- permanently. So before she can stop her own mouth from moving, she says the only thing she can think of at the moment.

"I don't. I'm sorry."

Silence falls over the room, and suddenly there is a single tear falling down Catra’s cheek. Adora’s heart shatters with it. She made her cry. She has known this woman for years, personally been by her side for one and she has never, ever seen her cry

before. And she fucking made her cry. Adora's chest hurts like some higher power is punishing her for making their goddess cry. Catra has just given herself to her, begged her to admit any sort of feeling for her, and Adora had the gall to say she doesn't feel the same. She's such an idiot.

"Catra? Catra, I'm so sorry, please-"

"You need to leave, Adora."

Before she can get another word out a knock sounds at the door. Right, that must be her resting fill-in for the night. Catra would have heard them approach before she heard them knock. Adora looks back to the magicat princess, ignoring the door for the time being and not even giving them a second thought of acknowledgment. Catra is staring at her, another tear haven fell down her cheek, and visibly upset. If it wasn't for the tears one would think she was just simply angry. But Adora can read her better than most.

"What do you want me to do?"

"Well, your detail is here so you can sleep. You should probably go. It's an order, right? You like those."

"...Catra"

She flips over on her bed, pulling the covers up to her shoulders and burrowing down between the pillows and blankets surrounding her. "Make sure the door is closed."

She is beaten. Catra will not talk to her anymore- at least for tonight, and Adora must rest before she fully collapses. The knock sounds again at the door, jolting her in her place and urging her to finally move, separating herself from Catra with one last glance. She has half a mind to wish her good night before her better judgment stops herself. She would not appreciate it right now.

Adora gathers up the remaining pieces of her armor that lay scattered on the floor, gathering them up like some haphazard

industrial walk of shame. She takes one last look over her shoulder at Catra, but she’s still turned away from her in her bed, wild hair sticking out in all different directions. As Adora pulls open the doors the guard waiting outside jolts upright and salutes her, stepping out of the way to let her pass.

"Guard her with your life," she instructs.

The guard's eyes widen a little in shock before stammering. "Y-yes sir."

Adora marches down the hall towards the barracks with armor in hand, not noticing the side glance from the fill-in.

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As soon as she gets to her chamber the armor is thrown, crushing against the wall of the other side of the room and falling all over her desk and chair there. She sits on her bed with an over-exaggerated huff, untying the rest that wasn't removed earlier, kicking off her braces with too much force.

A voice in the back of her mind is telling her to breathe, that she's being too dramatic and possibly calling attention to herself. But stars, what else can she do? She just made one of the greatest mistakes in the span of her whole life. Actually, it has to be the worst- no contest.

She can only blame herself, really. What did she think was going to happen after? That they would move on and continue talking about her battle? Converse like normal and go about their days like nothing had happened? No. Adora had consorted her, and the Princess had all but confessed her feelings to her after she had given her something so personal to her, and all she did was have the gall to tell her didn’t feel the same- that she didn’t feel anything for her.

But that’s the problem, isn’t it?

Adora halts her pacing in front of the mirror propped up on her desk. She doesn’t even remember when she started pacing

anyway. How does she feel about her? She feels an overwhelming urge to serve her, that’s for sure. And she would lay her life on the line to protect her, but why?

Catra had asked her that many times tonight. She doesn’t regret becoming her knight, far from it, but she doesn’t know why she wants to be here so badly. She knows what she wants to do, she just doesn’t know why.

Maybe it’s the position. The recognition, the power of being a top general, and the guard of her kingdom's most beloved princess. She was raised to be powerful, she was raised to seek power. This is what her father trained her to do since she was young. Be the strongest- or be nothing at all. If she wanted to be a knight, she had to be the best. And the best position was at her side.

Adora sighs before turning away from her reflection in the mirror. She can’t stand looking at her own beat-down reflection longer than she already has. After everything that she’s been through today, she must rest before her early rise in the morning.

-

“Adora… 'Dora.”

Adora comes to consciousness with a sweet voice calling her name. She blearily opens her eyes, muscles coming to life as she adjusts herself from the solid sleep she had fallen into. She feels as if she has fully molded into her thin mattress as delicate fingers glide down her jawline and leave a burning trail in their wake.

“C-catra? What- what’s wrong, why are you here?”

Catra's kneeling over her blanketed body, legs spread wide over the width of Adora’s massive thighs. She should maybe be worried that Catra got this far without waking her.

"You want me?" She asks, voice slipping through her lips like warm velvet. Her hands slide down to the apex of Adora's hips, resting on either side of the small happy trail there, pushing the

blanket down in the midst. The warmth of the palm of her hands against her skin very nearly burns. She doesn’t fully recall stripping down before slipping into her bed for the night, but it’s not uncommon. At this exact moment, she can’t say she regrets it either.

Her breathing grows heavy, chest rising as she lifts her arm up to grab the pillow under her head. Catra looks down at her with hooded eyes. The jewels there bore into hers, almost as if they were reading the very pages of the open book that is her soul. She figures she must already know the answer, but is waiting to hear her say it. Adora’s brain still hasn’t been able to catch up with the fact that Catra, for the first time, has come to visit her in her room unprompted. After their argument and the way things were left, she doesn’t see what would make Catra come to visit her this late. As she’s mulling it all over, her mouth is moving before she can think out the words.

"Infinitely," she breathes.

She grins down at her, beautiful falls of silky brown hair spill over her shoulders and down her narrow back, caressing her beautiful sun-kissed and freckled skin perfectly. The small amount of light in Adora's room does her no justice. With no natural light, there's a heavy shadow cast over them, nothing but the soft glow of her lantern illuminating their features. She's wearing the same chemise silk robe as earlier, but Adora's far too preoccupied to wonder how she got here unseen.

Catra's hand has slipped down to the tip of her shaft, delicate fingers dancing there lightly around the head. Adora grips the pillow under her head and wishes she had a headboard to hold on to for the first time in her life. Catra shifts then, lowering her body directly on top of Adora's now, bare cunt resting against her dick. Her robe billows around them.

Her eyes nearly roll into the back of her head at the sensation. Her Highness is so unbelievably warm against her and, just like

her hands, feel almost too hot to bear. All she wants is to drown in it.

She wants more. She’s always going to want more, she fears.

But all she wants is Catra. All she wants to feel is Catra. The warmth of her pussy against her cock, the slick of her desire slipping between them, the part of her beautiful lips around the slight curve of her shaft, the delicate peaks of her supple breasts. All she wants is more of her.

Catra's hand still hasn't moved from the tip, the soft pads of her fingertips moving in circles around the head to tease her. Her lips part more as she presses down slightly harder on their junction, seeking more pressure and letting out a small breath at the change.

"Will you service me, my knight?"

Adora ignores how embarrassingly shaky her breath is as she pushes herself to speak. "Forever."

She smiles again, one of her canines peaking over the corner of her lip as she rolls her hips down in one fluid motion, gliding perfectly along Adora's shaft. They both gasp in unison, the brunette's a little airier as Adora feels her clit briefly rub against the head of her cock. Adora’s thoughts become utterly lost as she feels the glide of her lips along her shaft again when Catra repeats the motion. The magicat looks down at her, cheeks rosy and eyes hazy with lust.

"Promise?" She whispers.

Always

Her hand moves behind the beautiful curve of her ass, fingers wrapping awkwardly around the base of her cock.

Anything for her

She leans forward, pressing stomach to stomach as her hips roll down, pushing the head into her opening before it misses and slips out of the slick there. Catra silently curses as her haste gets the best of her.

Everything for her

She adjusts the placement of her legs, moving lower and widening them some more before pressing down again in another defined roll of her hips. This time, as her head presses in, it's welcome in the warm heat of the magicat’s perfect cunt, sliding in inch by inch as she guides her in further. Catra's face turns to pure bliss as she sighs, in relief and satisfaction, as a gentle heat creeps over her cheeks. Her eyes are pressed shut as she revels in the new foreign object, resting back on her knees as she adjusts to her size.

A few seconds pass until she opens her eyes, blinking down at Adora slowly. Her grin returns to her face as her pretty eyes softly glow in the light of the lantern, slits of striking colors boring into her from above. "You're so big, 'Dor," she murmurs as she leans down over her, sliding her arms up the bed until her hands are resting next to the blonde's head. Her delicate hands encapsulate the sides of her face, thumbs resting on her cheekbones with her fingers woven into her loose hair. She can feel the slight prick of her sharp nails against her scalp.

"Say it," she says, pulling Adora's bottom lip down with her teeth.

Adora grunts.

"Say it, 'Dora," she repeats. She rocks up on her body, her hips continuing to roll down on her roughly as she takes her in again and again. Her breathing is growing heavier, and Adora can tell she's already getting closer to her edge. "Say you love me."

Adora's eyes snap open then, broken out of her loop of stupor. "W-what?" She’s dumbfounded, taken aback by Catra's statement. She didn't expect her to say something like that.

"Say it, 'Dor. Say you love me." Adora continues to look up at her blankly with no words building. Catra's grinning at her, still moving rhythmically on her hips. "Come on, big girl. You owe me that much."

You owe it to her

“Say it.”

Say it

She deserves that

“Adora!”

Adora jolts up suddenly to a pounding knock on her door and becomes immediately aware that she is no longer in the dark of her room, but rather bright light from the sliver of her window. Her face flushes an embarrassing shade of crimson as her mind catches up with the rest of her body. Everything suddenly makes sense. How Catra got to her room dressed the way she was, how she got so far on top of Adora without waking her up, why she had come to see her in the middle of the night after their argument.

Catra never came to visit her, she had simply dreamt of her. Her face is burning, and shame flows through her body as she catches a glance at the sheets below her.

The knock on her door sounds again, and she shoves her self-pity to the side in favor of answering her door. If they have the nerve to bother her this early, it has to be something important. It better be.

She throws the blanket off herself as she stands, grabbing the closest pair of trousers and shirt as she tries to conceal her less-than-ideal appearance before opening the door and greeting her reporting officer. Their eyes widen once they see her, face paled as they salute.

"Sir, the Princess is missing."

Chapter End Notes

ummm
my bad

tbh im not in a well headspace rn, but I wanted to post this for you guys since it's been a while since I updated it, and I love this fic a lot. Please excuse any errors, as I said I'm going through some very stressful times right now, so if there's any errors i promise ill fix since i know it can ruin a fic sometimes. <3333

Thank you

@cayatelynn on twitter

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

> TW: mention of a passed animal. Skip section with *** to avoid!! there are TWO sections, both are very short. It's plot-relevant and will make sense when you read it- but just a warning.
> Adora also describes her passed self in that 2nd section, but neither is in detail. I will summarize why in end notes
>
> Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Her soldiers, without a doubt, are the dumbest lot there ever was.

The Princess is *missing.* Guards were stationed at her personal door, guards at every main door in the building, guards patrolling the perimeter outside- never mind the fact two should always be patrolling the woods outside her apartment, and yet she's *gone.* They all had *one* job, and they all failed. Someone, apparently, snuck in through these multitudes of guards unnoticed and took her. And now she’s somewhere unknown, unsafe, in danger, and she has failed her job. She has failed to protect the one she is sworn to keep safe.

She feels like her blood is boiling under her skin as she storms down the hall, flagged by the two guards that were stationed outside the room. She could strip them of their title now. She *should* after the complete failure they've executed tonight.

But really it's her failure, isn't it? She is her personal guard, the one in charge of training the detail and the soldiers directly under her. If they have failed to perform their basic duties, it falls under her. Ultimately, this has to be her fault. She has failed the Princess by not protecting her the way she has promised to, the way she has expected to be. She has failed Catra. She let her down again.

The two guards behind her are chittering incessantly, bantering about who heard what or what happened. Adora’s patience wears thin with the annoying trill of their back and forth. She stops, spinning on her heel and facing them. They come to a dead stop with a loud clanking of armor, faces turning pale as they look at her wide-eyed.

“If you didn't hear anyone enter, then how is it you found the Princess missing? Am I to believe you could simply tell by the air? How am I to believe *you* aren't responsible for it?”

The guards gape, shooting each other a glance before the one on the right, the older one named Farlas, salutes and then speaks.

“We- we heard a crash, Sir. We knocked and when the Princess did not answer we announced our entry before checking. She was not there. At no point did she leave the room through us.”

She surveys them, watching as they stand there waiting for Adora to release them. They fidget slightly, but it could be nothing more than nerves. She doesn't miss how often they shoot each other looks or glances, but nothing about their behavior is immediately telling to them being involved with the kidnapping. She decides to pocket it for later due to more pressing matters of actual investigation and report, but they'll remain on her list of suspects- no doubt.

She lets out an exasperated sigh, turning and continuing down the long and dimly lit hall to her Highness’ room. They follow behind her timidly.

The first thing she notices upon entry is that the room is exactly in order. Well, how she left it. The Princess is notoriously not the most orderly royal out there, as this is something she has constantly seen her mother chastise her about. She is also not messy, but more of an in-between the two. She has what she needs where she wants, and she does not allow maids to enter her room without her there, so she can keep it how she likes. Her bed is half unmade, having been used just moments ago. The

slight imprint from where she rested is still evident in the twists and folds of the blankets and pillows. The large glass doors to her balcony are open, which is not unusual. Hence the constant guards patrolling The woods outside. The balcony itself has no traces of dirt, mud, or any tracks that would indicate someone had entered through the balcony by the woods, ignoring the possibility that someone was already waiting in her room. Adora doesn't even allow herself to blush at the idea of what they would've seen. Catra would've been able to smell the unknown presence in her room. No sign of a fastener, a rope, a chip in the stone railing- anything that would indicate someone had climbed up. When she looks to the woods, she can see the glint of the armor from her two guards patrolling, hidden in the brush of Halfmoon's surrounding wildlife. She brings her fingers up to her mouth and lets out a high-pitched whistle. The guards stop, coming into view of the balcony. Adora raises her hand to signal a code.

Code Aquari. Missing Princess.

The guards acknowledge, salute, and disappear into the brush once again to investigate for any trails, clues, signals- just about anything worth reporting back to her.

After giving the balcony one last look over, she turns back to the room. "The crash?" She questions.

The other guard, Sasha, points to the floor by the door. There lies a broken vase, with cuts on the wall above from where it must've hit, right next to the door that leads to the hall. The vase, however, picks at the back of her brain, and after a moment of searching, she recognizes it. It's a vase that she favors, an iridescent orange glass that was blown in the village by a local shop and gifted to her by her father, often kept on the stand by her large windows. She has put her favorite flowers, bluebells, in it occasionally.

Her wardrobe doors remain open and missing a few clothes from the rack. The vase near the balcony doors, across the room,

shattered. No tracks, no sign of any scuffle, nothing. Adora moves towards the nightstand right of her bed where she knows she keeps her gold and miscellaneous trinkets. When she opens the drawer, she can not stop the put-out sigh that escapes her frame.

“Sir?”

“You fools. She wasn't kidnapped. She ran.”

The guards, reasonably, are shocked. She can understand why. A princess, soon to take the throne, running away from a life of luxury? It’s unheard of. She understands how they would be confused. She owes them an apology for accusing them earlier, but her nerves still do not ease. She was still able to run between her guards unnoticed. But if she was the one to evade her guards, she supposes she shouldn’t be so harsh on them. Her highness is exquisite in everything she does, after all.

“What makes you so sure?” Sasha prods.

Adora considers, for a moment, if she should share that info. She could be being played a fool. These guards could be fantastic actors- feigning shock and disbelief at the information to gather insight into the investigation. But she knows her Princess. She knows how skilled and how headstrong she is, and knows if she really was kidnapped this room would be torn to shreds in the process. There's not even a tear or a spec of blood anywhere, and her lady of the Moon is ferocious when faced. These guards, also, have never given her a direct reason to question their loyalty to Halfmoon before, and sharing this info could serve as a test down the line if she only shares it with them.

“Look at the room. She's missing her travel clothes from the wardrobe. Do kidnappers usually make sure to grab you a spare of clothes here? There's no sign of tracks or a grapple anywhere on the balcony, but the vase usually near the window, that they would have had to exit from, is thrown across the room, to purposefully shatter- gaining your attention and need to

investigate to find she was gone. Her gold from the nightstand, as well, is gone. This was planned and solely executed."

The guards murmur something she cannot hear, but she pays it no mind. Her concern, now, is on *why.* Why would she run, why would she stage this? She could've made a clean escape, making sure to cover her tracks, but she chose to throw the vase and alert the guards. If she wanted to run, she could've been half a day away before anyone knew she was gone.

Please tell me you feel it too

She…she couldn't have. Did she leave because of Adora?

She feels sick.

"Sir-"

Just then the doors to the room burst open, revealing an unmistakably lethal Magikat in its wake. The queen stands there, ears pinned back and tail lashing as her face contorts in absolute rage. Her guards jump into a salute, doing their best to conceal their nervousness under their glazed glare. She knows what's coming before it happens. The Queen storms over, night robe billowing behind her as she faces Adora, bringing her hand down and sticking her against the face. She feels the burn against her cheek and knows she has left gashes from her claws, but she does not move to touch them. She simply lowers her head and salutes her Queen.

"Kneel," she spits.

She does without question.

She sneers down at her and she cannot blame her. Her daughter is missing yet her personal guard still stands unscathed. "You Were supposed to protect her. *Guard* her. You. Failed. I should have your head for this."

Her guards almost drop to come to her aid. She sends them a glare that stops them in their tracks before they can demonize themselves. She supposes they may be loyal, after all.

“I will find her. I will bring her home.”

Queen Kytta guffaws at her statement. “And what's stopping me from sending one of my more *trusted* knights? Clearly, you can not do it if you cannot so much as watch my daughter while she sleeps.”

She may know her Princess more than anyone else, but she does still know her Queen, as well. She may love her daughter in her own way, but she does not truly know her. Not like Adora.

“Whoever took her waited until I was relieved. This was planned, but they will not succeed. I will find her by sunset, and see that they are executed by my hand personally.”

The Queen snarls. “So I am to blame your guards, then? I should-”

“My guards' actions are mine. I trained them, and so I will take responsibility for their faults.”

“Oh, I intend to see to it.”

She bends, grabbing Adora's chin roughly and yanking her face up to meet her glare. “My daughter. Or your head at sunset.”

She throws her chin from her hand, shaking it as if she had touched something dirty and rubbing it on Her gown. She does not forget to glare at the guards as she passes, meeting her own in the hall before slamming the door to the room shut pointedly.

“We-,” one of her guards starts.

Adora sighs, holding up her hand to silence them and standing while placing her hand against her burning cheek. It's warm, and

when she brings her hand down to inspect her fingers are coated in a lush red. Magnificent. A brand to show her failure.

“You forget your ears,” she murmurs.

The guards look confused for a moment before she sees realization strike on their faces. They're not exactly rookies, but they're some of her newer guards. They may have forgotten the magikat's excellent range of hearing, and she would like to spare them from a heartbroken mother’s wrath right now.

They wait a few moments longer before speaking when they feel she is far enough away that she cannot hear them. “You lied.”

It's not a question, but a statement. They don't look accusatory or angry, but she can recognize where they're coming from. They just watched their commanding officer lie to their direct superior about her daughter's whereabouts. They have cause for concern.

“Telling her that her daughter ran away would only infuriate her more and cause her to send an army after her in rage. That would alert the Princess before they even got close and they would never find her. Searching for her discretely is the best option tactically.”

They look unsure. “Shouldn't we have told her Majesty that, Sir?”

Adora frowns, questioning herself. Should she? She runs through her thoughts once more before deciding that, no, if Catra was to be found, she would be the best option to find her. “She wouldn't have listened to me. This is the best option to rescue the Princess.”

They say no more but acknowledge her decision. Whether or not they agree she doesn’t know, doesn’t care. She does become briefly worried that they'll report this insubordination to the Queen, but when she watches their movements they give her no immediate cause for concern. Their body language at least doesn't show they have a goal in mind once they leave the room.

“You're dismissed. Return to your rooms and await further instructions. And… I apologize. For accusing you, earlier.”

The guards salute and leave without another word.

She returns to the balcony as soon as they exit the room, looking for what… she's not completely sure. She feels…odd. Like she’s missing an important piece of the plan. It doesn’t feel complete. Catra Left her. She ran the night they… did whatever they did, but she didn't leave a note or an inclination of where she was headed. The whole play of events is wrong, and it does not feel right as she runs it through her mind again and again. The questions she pressed her with before she left, the way she reacted to Adora's answers. She doesn’t think she would’ve run because of her, but could she have? She didn't seem happy with her earlier, but would that have been enough? There has to be something else she is missing.

In her train of thought she barely has time to register the small tock of wood from the brush. She jumps out of the way as soon as the arrow flies past her, completely avoiding her and hitting the stone wall behind her. She switches to the woods, doing what she can to adjust her eyesight and search through the brush for any sign or indication of the offenders. She sees nothing besides the lush green. She does not have the eyes of a magikat. It is far too dark for her eyes to adjust in enough time to have caught the intruder before possibly escaping. She turns back to the arrow on the wall, and her stomach drops when she sees it.

A note, attached to the arrow.

She moves swiftly, keeping her head low as she takes the note from it as fast as possible without damaging it and unfurling it to reveal pristine writing, not in the language of Halfmoon.

Sorcerers Grove

Sunset

A meeting at sunset, for what she can only hope to guess. An inkling of a promise of finding her, but possibly at the cost of her own life.

The choice has never seemed so easy.

She escapes the castle unnoticed, possibly an hour or so before sundown. If she were to leave any later, the Queen would most likely stop her- claiming that she was attempting to escape her ill fate. She knows the grove. It's a little way out into the woods, but she's been there before. It's a secluded little sanctum favored by quite a few locals of Halfmoon, a billowy soft grass plane surrounded by large lush willows, plants, and foliage. She remembers escorting Catra there some time ago with her magic instructor.

When she finally reaches the plane, the sun has finally begun to set in the sky. A stricken orange bleeds across the sky as the branches of the willow trees sway with the soft wind. As she nears the edge of the grove, she keeps her hand on the grip of her sword, hoisted at her side and ready to draw at the slightest movement or sound.

As if on cue, she hears the soft crunch of the grass from across the field when she's in eyesight. She tenses, moving to draw her sword and get in position to defend herself when the other person calls out to her.

"Wait!"

She doesn't recognize the voice. They sound shrill, frightened.

"Name yourself," she demands.

They don't. "We'll come out, but just so you know, we're armed. Just in case anyone else showed up!"

“Names,” she calls again, angrier.

Her face falls when she hears a familiar groan across the grove. A certain groan that has been burned into her brain throughout the past few years of her life.

“Just go,” she complains. “She’s not going to get you.”

Before she can speak, out steps three bodies from underneath a giant willow. One of them, an archer- clad in white and gold and purple undertones, a heart cut-out on his chest. The other, a shorter woman with pink and purple hair brushed to the side and wearing an outfit decorated head to toe in at least four different shades of purple alone, with a small golden circlet on her head. She appears to be naturally sparkling. Behind the two of them is Catra, who walks to the front, clearly undeterred and in no danger, wearing the brown and red travel clothes with gold accents that was missing from her wardrobe. Her body language is completely relaxed as she stands next to them, looking at Adora as if she is the one out of place. She takes the hint and stands, fully re-sheathing her sword but keeping her hand on the pommel awkwardly.

The pink one leans over to whisper to Catra with wide eyes. “She’s scary as shit.”

Adora feels like she’s hallucinating. “What is this?”

Catra’s gaze softens, unfolding her arms and turning to the two strangers. “Adora, this is Bow and Glimmer from Brightmoon. We’ve been friends since I was little.”

Adora’s eyes widen. This is the archer from yesterday. They must have helped her escape, but why? Why would Catra do all this? How-

“How?”

Catra raises her brow, watching Adora curiously. “Did you really think I spent my whole life in Halfmoon? I’ve been sneaking out

long before you were assigned to me, Adora.”

Her gaze darts between the three of them. They’re all looking at her, studying her, watching her, looking for something she doesn’t recognize, but nonetheless uneasy. She asks the only question that comes to mind, the only thing she can focus on right now, besides the burning stares.

“Why did you do this?”

Catra adverts her gaze now, looking down towards the ground. Ashamed, maybe? She can’t fully tell with how far away she is.

“I wasn’t happy.”

She can’t help it, she makes a strained noise, jaw dropped as she watches Catra squint at the patch of ground she’s focused on with her reaction. “You…” Her train of thought fails her. She’s in disbelief. She wasn’t sure what she expected the reason to be if she was able to even find the reason why, but she wasn’t expecting this.

Catra’s mood changes suddenly to that of a more stern one, one with a goal in mind. She squares her shoulders, facing Adora directly again.

“Adora, I would like to introduce you to my fiancé,” she turns, angling her arm out to Glimmer.

Her face falls, and she struggles to keep her curdling emotions hidden as she feels her stomach sour and her skin burn in resentment. It's a bitter feeling that she can no longer deny lives within her.

“There,” Catra points at her face, directing her attention back to her and away from the woman who started to shrink under her gaze. “Jealousy.”

Adora feels her eyes grow wide. “I-”

“Don't deny it. I can see right through you. I wouldn't have asked you to bed me if I thought you didn't like me.”

“...I didn't know you were betrothed,” she settles on instead, dumbfounded.

Catra sighs, dropping her arm. “It's a secret engagement. They claim it was to not cause a ruckus before the actual ceremony week, but I know my parents. Much to Brightmoon’s dismay, they're simply waiting for the chance of a better offer before my,” she brings her hands up to mimic her mother speaking. “‘Time is up.’”

Glimmer snickers and Catra rolls her eyes without looking at her. “One they’ll never get,” she jests.

Adora doesn’t know what that means. She’s not sure she wants to ask.

“They would expect me to have children, Adora. Not just one- *children* . Can you imagine *me* with children? A backup for Halfmoon, a backup for Brightmoon.”

“I still don't understand,” she cuts in. “You've been friends since childhood, so why not just wed and then run? Why do all of this before the wedding?”

“Don't call it a wedding. There's no love involved. My parents are bargaining me off for power, not for me to be happy. We're friends, but we don't love each other. It's a ceremony.”

There's no anger in her words as she speaks to Adora. If anything, she shows disdain for her parents.

“It would have been an official union,” she continues. “A contract between our two kingdoms that we would have been expected to serve, and while under the public eye. Vanishing after that would've caused more of a ripple effect than it would doing this now. Glimmer's mother, additionally, respects her right to wed who she chooses. If I ran after the ceremony, there would be

issues of legality if she chose to marry later on, and my parents would direct their ill-advised anger on Brightmoon for not being able to tie me down.”

She reaches Adora then, placing a gentle hand against the small stitches on her cheek from the infirmary. “My mother did this, didn't she?” She whispers, sullen, as she looks at her with eyes all too soft for someone like Adora.

She doesn't answer but places her hand over the one on her cheek. Catra closes her eyes and sighs.

“If I thought she would harm you like this I would've planned differently. I'm so sorry, Adora.”

When she speaks next, it's not accusing, nor is it harsh, but she feels it is something she must let her know.

“She wants my head, Catra.”

Catra's face steels as she focuses on her, eyes resolute. “When?”

She takes a deep breath in. “Sunset.”

“Good.”

Adora gapes at her. She can see she's not the only one confused by the glance she sees Bow and Glimmer send each other over her shoulder.

“Uh, Catra-” Bow starts.

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“She wants you dead? Fine. They'll send Merr out to track you when you don't return soon. But they won't find you alive, they'll find your body. There's a dead animal somewhere that way,” she points. They all turn to look as if they'll see anything but trees. “I've smelled it since we arrived. It has to be no more than a day old. Glimmer will use her cloaking spell to disguise it as your body,

which unfortunately passed in the fight to capture me," she turns to Glimmer and she nods. "You will have died a loyal knight who followed her last order to the very end, to capture the rouge Princess who betrayed her kingdom. If… that is something you want."

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Her brows furrow. "To die poisoning your name?"

"To be with me, Adora."

She grabs her hands, pulling them down and resting them against the sides of her face as she looks up at her with pleading eyes. "I don't care about my legacy. Don't you get it? I love you. I always have. I thought last night would be enough to show it, but I guess it wasn't. I should have said it then but I couldn't seem to get the words out. For one reason or another, that's my fault. But please, Adora. One last time- what am I to you?"

"You're…" she thinks about the possibilities here. Is there a possibility Catra could really be happy with her down the line? A knight and a princess is outrageous. Could she make her that happy, truly? Someone who's lived a life of luxury, who would have anyone glad to call her theirs, retrospectively speaking. Catra seems to think she will. She thinks, also, of what Catra had asked her the night before.

What do you want, Adora?

You are a person, not just a knight. You deserve to have dreams outside of the castle, outside of being a knight. What do you want?

Is it so sinful to want someone you can't have, even if they want you, too?

If Catra left here, if she let her go without following her, what would happen to Adora if she escaped her death? Her heart wouldn't beat so fast anymore, that's for sure. She could return to

her duties on the front full-time, the burning feeling she'd become so used to feeling would switch with that burning cut of steel against skin in battle. She would sleep alone, which she has, with the thought of her lost princess on her mind, plaguing her with imagery that would fade over time with their distance. Her future endeavors would be unbeknownst to her. She would become a stranger to Adora, someone she no longer knows anything about.

She can't let that happen. A world without Catra? She'd rather face the Queen empty-handed.

She wants her. She's been fighting it for a year, but she can't help the way her heart beats faster whenever she looks at her. She can't help that she finds herself dreaming of her eyes whenever her gaze lingered a little too long that day. She can't help that she fell head over heels for the most stubborn, cunning, brave, rebellious, and beautiful woman Etheria has ever seen. Her next words flow out of her mouth like the sweetest wine she's ever tasted.

"My love. I love you. So much, I-"

Catra's smile is wide and absolutely lovely as she jumps onto Adora and wraps her arms around her neck. Adora's arms immediately wrap around her lithe body, spinning her around as they laugh in glee, or perhaps a wave of relief. When Adora sets her down, her cold hands are on her cheeks just as quickly, pulling her down for an unparalleled kiss full of love, hope, and an unspoken promise. She hears Glimmer retch behind them, followed by Bow's quick shush. the sun behind them is mostly set now, coloring the sky with a pallet of red, orange, and purple.

They're about to press their lips together again when Bow steps closer to them, breaking the moment sheepishly. "Sorry, we should get going. Knowing your mom she's probably already set up a team to track Adora."

Catra sighs, grabbing one of Adora's hands and turning closer to her friends. "No, you're right," She stops, turning to look over her

shoulder to Adora. “The plan?” She questions. She’s asking for her input.

Adora smiles, bringing her hand up and tapping the side of her nose. “Our scents,” she supplies. Catra was right. Merr will most definitely be leading whatever team the Queen sends out to find her, and he will most definitely be able to tell there are four different scents here, recognize her and Catra’s, and be able to track them beyond the grove. Magikats are no fools to magic, it’s in the very name.

Catra smiles, turning to Bow. For some reason his eyes light up, and he gasps in joyous glee. “I told you it was useful!”

The blonde watches as he reaches behind his shoulder to pull out an arrow with a narrow, golden-encased capsule on the end. “Scent bomb arrow!” He declares. “For all your vanishing needs.”

Glimmer groans, covering her face with her hand.

Adora laughs then. A loud, boisterous laugh that has them all turning to her in shock. She isn’t sure what it is. Maybe it’s the stress from the day finally making its way out of her body, the death threats, the exhaustion weighing on her bones, or the absurdity of it all, but it just rolls out of her to the point of tears forming in the corner of her eyes. She wipes the tears away, meeting Catra’s worried gaze as she does so. “I like these friends of yours,” and then, without fully meaning to, “I’m exhausted.”

Catra’s gaze relaxes, brows raising in sympathy as she uses the arm she’s currently holding to pull her down closer to her again, placing a soft kiss against her lips. Adora’s heart has never felt so big. “Then let’s hurry and go. The animal?” She asks the group, slightly unnerved.

“I will get it,” she offers. “I do not mind.”

She turns from the group, placing a quick kiss on her beloved’s hand before parting, not missing Glimmer’s complaint of being

insufferable. She does not mind. She will shower Catra with every ounce of affection in her for the rest of her life.

***

The animal, an adult moon funnel elk, if not far from the grove. Adora whispers an apology before using one of the giant plumeria leaves nearby to wrap around it like a gurney, carrying it back to the grove as carefully and quickly as possible. Catra was right. It’s fresh, natural causes most likely, but it has started to smell. It should still be easy enough to cloak, depending on how skilled Glimmer is.

When she returns to the group, Catra is writing a note on one of the nearby slabs of rock as Bow watches Glimmer concentrate on preparing her spell. Catra finishes what she is writing as she places the elk gently on the ground near the center, throwing the leaf into the nearby brush. She watches as Catra kneels next to it, offering an apology and a silent prayer for it before backing away to make room for Glimmer. The spell, to her relief and disgust, works perfectly the first time. She and Catra both advert their gazes as soon as the figure changes.

Glimmer sucks in a breath. “Wow, that is, uh, really accurate. Good for us, right? Go me. Let's leave.”

Catra's ear flicks then, her head snapping around to face the edge of the grove Adora had come from earlier. Adora can not hear anything herself, but she’s sure bodies are approaching them. “Quickly,” she adds. “Let’s move out of the grove before teleporting, the foliage will conceal us better.”

The three of them start to move, running out of the grove in the opposite direction of the approaching sound. Adora is stuck in place. Next to her lies a copy of her deceased self, a perfect replica of her in the same armor she’s worn for years, bloodied with claw marks scattered on her pale skin and deep cuts in the plating. There’s a saying to apply here, no doubt, but the words do not come.

***

“Hey.”

She looks up towards the soft, husky voice she’s come to know so well. Catra is looking at her with so much love in her eyes it is almost like a dream, hand outstretched towards her still figure. “You coming?”

She feels a smile bloom on her face, reaching her hand out to take Catra’s waiting one. She grasps her hand, pulling her with her as she starts running again, the both of them laughing as they disappear into the brush of the woods.

Always

To my parents;

Do not attempt to find me. You never will. This isn’t an invitation to try, it is just a fact. You’ve spent your life protecting me, giving me a life within Halfmoon I will forever be grateful for, but you have curated a life for someone that is not me. I will not be tied to someone I do not love. I will not live in a kingdom I do not know. I will not be used as a pawn with egregious rules and ordinances to follow at the expense of my happiness, so I have run. I have killed the guard you sent after me as proof of my commitment, and I will do the same for any others you send.

Forgive me or not, Halfmoon will survive.

Chapter End Notes

Can you believe I had nothing to do at work today so I wrote this whole last chapter from start to finish?

In My Loyalty is complete! I really enjoyed this fic since it's an untraditional structure, starting with naystay smut first then moving into plot/ story. Maybe not super un-heard of nowadays, but still fun. In other good news- don't be surprised if I post any bonuses for this fic eventually ;)
I also want to add that I don't hc Catra as religious. when I say that she prays for it- its more along the lines of forest-nature magic, that I see magikats being proficient in.

Active on my fan twit @cayatelynn, and would love to answer any fic questions/hc's anything really on ngl, esp for this since I just finished it :'). link is in my twitter bio for everything

Thanks!

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1st- Catra mentions there's an unfortunately naturally passed animal nearby that they can use to fake adora's death.
2nd- Adora goes to get the animal, catra thanks/prays for it with nature-based magic, glimmer casts the spell and it works. Adora looks at the imagery of her fake passed self, and its jarring, but it provides symbolism.
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End Notes

my 2nd smut fic ever on god its easier to write the second time around

I tried to work in a lot of themes from spop for them so if you noticed some of them let me know! tried my best to do it well so I hope I did
I'm very active on my spop twit/main @cayatelynn. i will be posting the themes I tried to include there as well as the pintrest I made to inspire me for this chapter. i also often post fic updates, hc's and just like to talk so follow me !!!
comment comment comment! love keeps me going

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!